

Chapter 69-4

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Since it was Sunday, when Liang Shi drove the car to South Gate Two, she couldn't find a parking spot at all, so she drove the car to a place far away, parked it properly, then walked back from there.

The wind was strong at night. Liang Shi put her already-dried coat on Xu Qingzhu.

An Alpha's build was slightly larger, so the clothes were correspondingly bigger as well.

Xu Qingzhu wore it like an oversized garment, folding the sleeves up one layer.

They had just arrived not long ago when Sally and Lin Luoxi also came.

Xu Qingzhu was surprised: "Why are you two together?"

Sally answered: "We were playing cards together."

But Lin Luoxi looked listless, glancing at Sally sideways, yet unusually didn't retort at her.

"What's wrong?" Xu Qingzhu asked in a low voice: "Did you lose money?"

"Mm." Lin Luoxi responded weakly: "Lost over ten thousand."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"Playing that big?" Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue. "Who were you two playing with?"

"With two of our friends." Lin Luoxi stared at Sally's back, pressing her temples¹, her body also unable to hold up. She hooked her arm around Xu Qingzhu's, resting her head on Xu Qingzhu's shoulder. Since the two had similar heights, this posture was a bit awkward for her, but ultimately her body won out. She asked with particular incomprehension: "Why do some people, after all these years, still act like dogs²?"

Xu Qingzhu didn't understand: "What do you mean?"

Lin Luoxi glanced at her, then said in a low voice: "After doing it, she still had to drag me to play cards for a whole day. I don't understand."

Xu Qingzhu: "???"

Her pupils震惊³, "Doing it? Is it the 'doing it' I understand?"

"What else?" Lin Luoxi took a step up, her legs trembling weakly. But she was leaning on Xu Qingzhu, and Xu Qingzhu almost tripped as well. Fortunately, Liang Shi reached out to support her in time, then said helplessly: "Cherry, how about I help you instead?"

"Don't." Lin Luoxi sighed. "I don't want to have unclear relationships with my bestie's wife."

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together: "Actually, for this kind of thing, I don't mind."

"I mind." Lin Luoxi said, straightening her body. "Playing cards for a whole day, my waist is about to break."

"Sally." Liang Shi called out to Sally who had been leading the way at the front. "Come over and help Cherry."

Sally immediately jogged over: "I thought she was going to cling to Blanche and not let go."

"You won, so you're afraid I'll hit you, right?" Lin Luoxi said through gritted teeth, then pinched Sally's arm. Sally sucked in a breath of cold air: "OMG, Blanche, save me!"

Xu Qingzhu stood to the side and shook her head: "I can't help you."

Liang Shi immediately pulled Xu Qingzhu to her side: "Don't involve innocent people in your couple's affairs."

Sally & Lin Luoxi: "....."

Both their expressions froze. Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "You two haven't made up yet?"

Lin Luoxi cleared her throat: "Currently not a couple yet."

Sally looked aggrieved on the side: "She won't agree to be with me."

Lin Luoxi couldn't help it and pinched her again: "Why won't I agree? Don't you have any idea?"

So the two started arguing again.

But this argument ended very quickly.

Liang Shi hadn't been to this place before, but the three of them were regulars.

Entering the hot and sour noodle shop that Xu Qingzhu mentioned, it was practically packed with people.

"After all these years, this shop is still so popular." Lin Luoxi said: "I haven't been here in so long."

Sally interjected from the side: "I came twice after returning to the country. I asked you to come that day, but you wouldn't."

"I haven't been here since graduating." Xu Qingzhu said.

This resulted in Sally and Lin Luoxi asking in unison: "How long ago did you graduate?"

Xu Qingzhu: ".....Not long ago."

The shop was lively, and their chatting back and forth was also lively. Liang Shi simply acted as a background character.

The legendarily devil-spicy hot and sour noodles made Liang Shi's eyes turn red from the first bite. She drank many mouthfuls of water but still couldn't suppress it.

Yet it was quite fragrant, making one want to try a second bite.

Xu Qingzhu wasn't particularly good at eating spicy food either, but here, she stubbornly finished an entire bowl. It made her forehead break out in a layer of sweat and also made her eyes red. Her lip color became even more vivid than if she'd applied lipstick.

Afterward, they went to browse the entire snack street. Whenever they encountered something particularly delicious, Xu Qingzhu would stop to buy it.

In the end, they bought a whole bunch of things, but with many people, they divided it up quickly and didn't have much left.

Liang Shi ate quite full though.

After parting ways with Sally and the others, Liang Shi drove back to Qianshuiwan⁴. When passing by the central square, there was a building that was built very beautifully.

Light strips were wound around the rooftop, looking reassuring.

Liang Shi didn't see it—it was Xu Qingzhu sitting in the passenger seat who said: "Look at that building."

Liang Shi glanced over while waiting at a red light, then silently memorized the name of the residential complex.

Before bed, Liang Shi brought a cup of milk upstairs for Xu Qingzhu. Xu Qingzhu was sitting on the edge of the bed, not knowing what she was thinking about.

Liang Shi pushed open the door to see her tilting her head back slightly, her expression wooden.

Liang Shi placed the milk on the bedside table, instructing in a low voice: "Drink it and then rest early."

"I already slept all afternoon." Xu Qingzhu said: "Not very sleepy."

"You can read for a while." Liang Shi said: "Don't always think about random things."

"I'm not thinking about anything." Xu Qingzhu answered reflexively.

After answering, she fell silent again. When Liang Shi was about to say something, Xu Qingzhu had already changed the topic: "Liang Shi, let's go to the nursing home tomorrow afternoon."

"Huh?" Liang Shi was surprised: "You're not going to work?"

"I'll finish what needs to be done tomorrow morning, and we'll go around four in the afternoon." Xu Qingzhu said: "Going on a weekday should be better. Ask your supervisor for leave."

"Okay." Liang Shi agreed.

Liang Shi only told her to rest well, but after walking out of the room, she couldn't help but turn back, pushing open the door to say to her: "Teacher Xu."

Xu Qingzhu's cool voice rose slightly: "Mm?"

"Yaya called me at noon and asked us to come back for dinner." Liang Shi said: "I put her off, and then she asked us to come home next week."

"Alright."

"You see." Liang Shi smiled. "You're being loved by so many people."

Footnotes:

¹ Pressing temples (摁太陽穴) - A common Chinese gesture when one has a headache or is feeling stressed/tired, where one presses the temple area with fingers.

² Act like dogs (還是狗) - Chinese slang meaning someone is behaving badly, unreliably, or being a "dog" (derogatory), often used playfully among close friends to mean someone is being inconsiderate or annoying.

³ 瞳孔地震 - Literally "pupil earthquake," an internet slang expression meaning to be shocked or have one's mind blown, often used humorously to describe extreme surprise.

⁴ Qianshuiwan (淺水灣) - Literally "Shallow Water Bay," the name of the residential area where the characters live.